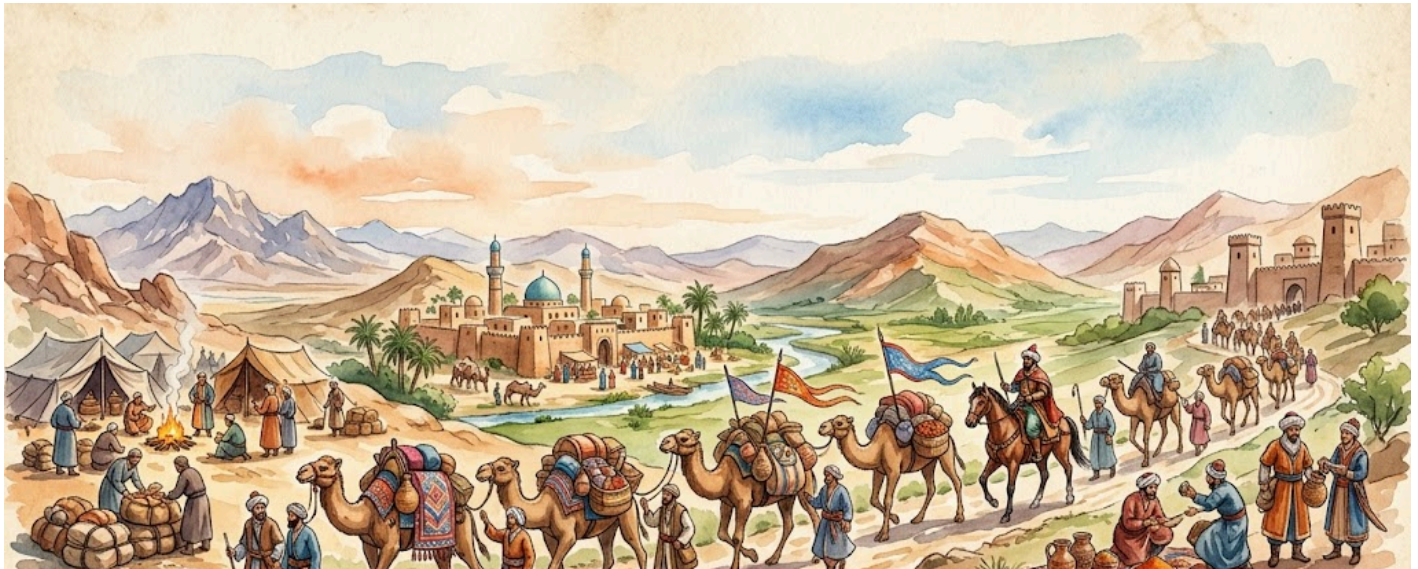


My Silk Road Journey

A story about trade, travel, and solving problems



You are a storyteller.

Tell the story of a merchant's journey along the Silk Road — the people, the problems, the choices, and what trade changed.

Name:	
Class:	
Date:	

Your assessment for Social Studies AND English.

How This Booklet Works

You will write a story with 4 parts. Each part has a job.

Beginning	Who you are and WHERE you are going.
Problem 1	A challenge close to you — and what you did.
Problem 2	A bigger challenge between countries — and what you did.
End	What you traded and what your journey CHANGED.

The 3 Sessions

Session 1	Plan your story. Write the Beginning.
Session 2	Write Problem 1 and Problem 2.
Session 3	Write the End. Polish. Copy it all out.

How Each Session Works

1. READ	Read the mentor paragraph. This is your example.
2. FIND	Find the important parts in the mentor paragraph.
3. WRITE	Fill in the blanks to write your own paragraph.

SESSION 1 — Plan Your Story

Before you write, plan WHO your story is about and WHY they are going.

1. My character's name is... *e.g. Mei, Hassan, Li*

2. My character is a... (trader / merchant / young helper / caravan leader) *Choose one or write your own.*

3. My character lives in... *e.g. Chang'an (China), Samarkand, Kashgar, Baghdad*

4. My character is travelling to... *e.g. Persia, India, Rome, the western marketplace*

5. The 3 goods my character is trading are... *e.g. silk, tea, spices, jade, paper, gold*

6. WHY is my character going? *(CAUSE — e.g. family needs money / silk is valuable far away)*

SESSION 1 — Write Your Beginning

◆ READ — Mentor Beginning

CAUSE → 'because my family needed money' ← look for this in the paragraph below

Long ago, in the year 100 BCE, I was a young trader named Mei. I lived in the busy city of Chang'an, in China. The streets smelled of cooking spices and tea. I wanted to travel to Samarkand because my family needed money, and silk could be sold for ten times its price in faraway lands. I packed my caravan with soft silk, dried tea leaves, and small bronze bells. I knew the journey would be hard, but I was excited and a little afraid.

 **Find it yourself (30 sec):** Circle the goods Mei packed. • Underline the feeling word at the end.

WRITE HERE — fill in the blanks:  character: young trader / merchant / helper
• feelings: excited, scared, hopeful, nervous

Long ago, in the year 100 BCE, I was a _____
named _____.

I lived in the city of _____. The streets smelled of
_____ and _____.

I wanted to travel to _____ because _____.

I packed my caravan with _____, _____, and
_____.

I knew the journey would be hard, but I was
_____.

✓ **Check:** ☐ I said WHO my character is and WHERE they live. ☐ I said WHERE they are going. ☐ I said WHY — that is the CAUSE.

SESSION 2 — Write Problem 1 (Local)

◆ READ — Mentor Problem 1

PREDICTION → 'if we did not stay together, we might be lost' ← look for this in the paragraph below

After two weeks of travel, we faced a problem. A huge sandstorm rose up from the desert. The wind was as strong as ten horses, and the sand stung my eyes. I felt scared because I could not see my friends. I said to my uncle, "What should we do?" He answered, "We must tie the camels together and lie down." I knew that if we did not stay together, we might be lost forever in the sand. So we decided to form a tight caravan and wait. As a result, when the storm passed, we were all safe.

 **Find it yourself (30 sec):** Underline the DIALOGUE (the words people SAY). • Circle the STRATEGY (the plan they made).

CHOOSE A LOCAL PROBLEM (your caravan only):

☐ Sandstorm ☐ Steep mountain pass ☐ Bandits on the road

WRITE HERE — fill in the blanks:  time: a few days, two weeks, one month • feelings: scared, worried, tired, brave

After _____ (days / weeks), we faced a problem.

The problem was: _____.

I felt _____ because _____.

I said to _____, "_____"

I knew that IF we did not _____, we MIGHT

_____.

SO we decided to _____.

AS A RESULT, _____.

✓ **Check:** ☐ I wrote what the problem was. ☐ I wrote DIALOGUE with quotation marks. ☐ I used an IF... MIGHT... prediction.

SESSION 2 — Write Problem 2 (A Bigger Problem)

◆ READ — Mentor Problem 2

STRATEGY → 'we made an alliance with three other groups' ← look for this in the paragraph below

Many days later, we faced an even bigger problem. We came to a road that crossed between two kingdoms. The kingdoms were fighting, and bandits hid in the rocks. I felt nervous, like a small bird near a cat. I whispered to my uncle, "How can we get past?" He said, "We must join other caravans and travel together." I knew that if we tried to cross alone, the bandits might take all our silk. So we made an alliance with three other groups of traders. As a result, we were too strong for the bandits, and we passed safely through the border.

 **Find it yourself (30 sec):** Underline the SIMILE (something compared with 'like' or 'as'). • Circle the STRATEGY word ('alliance', 'caravan', 'together').

CHOOSE A BIGGER PROBLEM (between countries / regions):

☐ War between kingdoms ☐ Language barrier at the marketplace ☐ Getting lost — route washed away

WRITE HERE — fill in the blanks:  *similes: like a small bird, like a stone, like ice; strategies: alliance, marketplace, translator*

Many days later, we faced an even bigger problem.

The problem was: _____.

I felt _____, like _____. (simile)

I whispered to _____, "_____"

I knew that IF we _____, we MIGHT _____.

SO we made an alliance with _____ / we worked together with _____.

AS A RESULT, _____.

✓ **Check:** ☐ This problem is bigger than the first one (between regions). ☐ I included a simile using 'like' or 'as'. ☐ I described the STRATEGY (alliance / cooperation / marketplace).

SESSION 3 — Write Your Ending

◆ READ — Mentor Ending

EFFECT → 'silk from China spread all the way to Rome' ← look for this in the paragraph below

Finally, after six long months, we arrived in Samarkand. The marketplace was the most colourful place I had ever seen. We traded our silk and tea for spices, jade, and shiny silver coins. Because of journeys like mine, silk from China spread all the way to Persia and even to Rome. Spices from India travelled back to Chinese kitchens. Stories and new words crossed the deserts and mountains with us. I learned that the Silk Road was not just a road for goods — it was a road for ideas, languages, and friendships between people.

 **Find it yourself (30 sec):** Circle THREE things that travelled along the Silk Road. • Underline what Mei learned at the end.

WRITE HERE — fill in the blanks:  describe the marketplace: colourful, busy, loud, sweet-smelling • spread: silk, spices, jade, ideas, languages

Finally, after _____ (weeks / months), we arrived in _____.

The marketplace was _____.

We traded our _____ for _____.

BECAUSE OF journeys like mine, _____ spread from _____ to _____.

I learned that _____.

✓ **Check:** ☐ I wrote what was traded. ☐ I wrote how trade SPREAD goods between places (the EFFECT). ☐ I said what my character LEARNED.

SESSION 3 — Polish Your Story

Use a coloured pencil to add details to your four paragraphs.

ADD 1 SENSORY DETAIL TO EACH PARAGRAPH

I SAW...	golden sand, tall mountains, busy market, shining silk
I HEARD...	wind howling, camels grunting, voices shouting
I FELT...	burning sun, cold wind, rough rope, smooth silk
I SMELLED...	spices, smoke, hot bread, dust, sweat

ADD AT LEAST 1 SIMILE TO YOUR STORY

- The desert was as hot as a fire.
- The wind was as strong as ten horses.
- My heart was beating like a drum.
- The mountain stood tall like a giant.
- The marketplace was as busy as a beehive.

Check and Fix

Dialogue:	"Let's go," she said. ✓ vs Lets go she said ✗
Capitals:	Names + places + 'I' + first word of sentence.
Adjective order:	three small wooden boxes ✓ wooden three small boxes ✗

My Self-Assessment

Tick the box that best fits your story.

Criterion	Yes ✓	Almost	Not Yet
My story has a Beginning, two Problems, and an End.	☐	☐	☐
My Beginning shows WHY my character is travelling.	☐	☐	☐
Each problem shows a STRATEGY and a PREDICTION (if... might...).	☐	☐	☐
My End shows what trade CHANGED (the EFFECT).	☐	☐	☐
I added sensory details (saw / heard / felt / smelled).	☐	☐	☐
I included dialogue with quotation marks.	☐	☐	☐
I used transition words (first, then, suddenly, finally).	☐	☐	☐
I wrote at least one simile.	☐	☐	☐
I checked my capitals and full stops.	☐	☐	☐



Now copy out your full story.

Put your four paragraphs together. You can:

- Write the full story in your ELA exercise book.
- Type it in a Google Doc.
- Make a Canva poster with your story.

Hand in BOTH this booklet AND your final story.

✂ - - - - - Tear here - - - - -

Reference Card — Tear Out and Keep Beside You

People	merchant, trader, caravan leader, helper, family
Places	desert, mountain, marketplace, oasis, city, road, river
Goods	silk, spices, jade, paper, tea, gold, salt, bronze
Actions	travel, trade, exchange, cross, climb, rest, talk, decide
Feelings	brave, scared, tired, hopeful, surprised, proud
Time words	first, then, next, after, suddenly, finally, days later
CAUSE words	because, so, since, as a result
PREDICTION words	if, then, might, could, would

SIMILES — try one of these or write your own

The desert was as hot as a fire. • The wind was as strong as ten horses. • My heart was beating like a drum. • The mountain stood tall like a giant. • The marketplace was as busy as a beehive.